

JML assignment

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Understanding	🧠 Crystal Clear
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Teacher(s)	👩‍🏫 Philip Köck
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JML-memoir

Our group's Rules of Engagement created a clear and structured framework for how we were expected to work together during the PCC project. The rules emphasized professionalism, respect, equal sharing of workload, clear communication, and collective responsibility. For example, we agreed that all members should understand all aspects of the project — not only their own individual tasks. This meant that every group member was involved in, and supportive of, all parts of the project, while also having the opportunity to share

input and reflections during the work process. These rules helped make the group work more transparent and reduced the risk that one person would be excluded, ignored, or left with an unfair amount of responsibility. Overall, it is evident that professionalism is not only about completing technical work, but also about creating a safe, fair, and respectful environment in which people can thrive collectively.

When reflecting on Dr. Willenbring's peer PhD-student's lack of action during the field expeditions, I think the most important lesson is that being passive can also contribute to an unsafe or unfair environment. Even if someone is not directly responsible for discriminatory or harmful behaviour, choosing not to react, not to support the affected person, or not to report the situation can allow the behaviour to continue. In that sense, silence is not neutral.

In my opinion, if I am not careful, I could end up in this situation 15 years from now. It is easy to imagine that I would always act correctly, but real situations can be complicated. There may be hierarchy, pressure from supervisors, fear of damaging one's career, or uncertainty about whether it is my place to intervene. Furthermore, the question of morality also becomes relevant. From one point of view, a person may refrain from taking action because they do not feel obligated to do so. From another point of view, a virtuous person may choose to intervene even if it creates problems, conflict, or personal consequences for their current situation, career, or economy. In a research or engineering environment, harmful behaviour can also become normalized if no one challenges it. That is why it is important to build habits and group structures that make it easier to act responsibly before a serious situation occurs.

Another important part of our rules is that issues should be raised early and discussed respectfully. If they cannot be solved inside the group, they can be escalated to the supervisor with the whole group's awareness. This is directly relevant to the question about preventing inaction. If I see someone being treated unfairly in the future, I should not wait until the situation becomes extreme. I should speak up early, check in with the affected person, document what happened, and use the correct channels to escalate the issue if necessary. Acting early is much easier than trying to repair harm after a long period of silence.

To prevent myself from ending up in the same situation 15 years from now, I need to develop the habit of being an active bystander. That means not only avoiding

discriminatory behaviour myself, but also responding when I see it. I can ask questions, challenge inappropriate comments, support colleagues who are being excluded, and make sure that decisions and responsibilities are transparent. I also need to be aware of power dynamics. If I become a senior researcher, supervisor, or project leader, my responsibility will be even greater, because silence from someone with authority can be interpreted as acceptance.